



GDD 31 Mutual

Mutual or nothing

The consent game for ages 15-18, at its adult peak. It teaches what consent truly is, a freely given, reversible, informed, enthusiastic, specific and ongoing 'yes' from both, the presence of a yes, not the absence of a no, how to read and respect cues, how to recognise and refuse coercion, and how mutual respect and equal power make intimacy safe and good. Even-handed, never explicit, never victim-blaming, with the strongest safeguarding in the app. Seven mechanics, 27 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Mutual or nothing.

Mutual is the consent thread brought to its deepest, most adult level, the destination of the bodily autonomy of My Body, My Rules (g2), the boundaries of Boundary Bot (g15) and the behaviour-reading of Green Light / Red Light (g24). It completes that arc for near-adults entering intimate relationships: what consent truly is, how to communicate it both ways, how to recognise and refuse coercion, and how mutual respect and equal power make a relationship safe and good. Its core idea is in its name, intimacy is mutual or it is nothing. Consent is reframed from the low bar of 'no didn't happen' to the real standard, a freely given, informed, enthusiastic, specific and ongoing 'yes' from both people, that either can withdraw at any moment. New v2 build; the strongest safeguarding in the app.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g31 · mutual (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 5 · ages 15-18 · adult / even-handed / non-explicit
Thread / topics	B · Safety, Consent & Boundaries · UNESCO 1.2, 4.2, 5.2, 5.3, 6.4, 7.2
Prerequisite / builds on	g30 (Status: Know It) · builds on g15 & g24 · underwrites g32
Gating	Sensitive 🚩 · consent never rushed; urgent disclosure routing
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the consent game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

17

myth-flips

27

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

The consent standard (FRIES). Consent is the presence of a **F**reely given, **R**eversible, **I**nformed, **E**nthusiastic, **S**pecific and ongoing 'yes' from both people, not the absence of a 'no'. Silence, freezing, going along, or a worn-down 'yes' are not consent; saying yes to one thing isn't yes to everything; and either person can stop at any moment. Anything given under pressure, manipulation or incapacitation isn't consent.

Near-adults, real intimacy.

From the Chapter 5 personas (15-18). Near-adults forming intimate relationships, often carrying damaging scripts (persistence is romance, a partner 'owes' intimacy). This game replaces those with the real standard, and it is even-handed throughout: anyone of any gender can be pressured, or be the one applying pressure.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Sneha, 17	To refuse guilt and pressure, and know it's never her fault.	role-play + strike-rewrite: refuse, no blame.
Vijay, 17	To check in, read cues, and find a genuinely mutual yes.	branch + role-play: the Mutual Zone.
Arjun, 17	To check his own behaviour and set an equal-respect tone.	branch + role-play: accountability.
The Counsellor	To route a disclosure to real help and state the law.	branch + match: safeguarding & helplines.

Why this works (the evidence). Consent is the presence of a freely given, reversible, informed, enthusiastic, specific, ongoing yes (FRIES), not the absence of a 'no'; silence, freezing or a worn-down yes don't count. Consent under pressure, guilt, threats or incapacitation isn't consent, and persistence is coercion, not romance. It's even-handed (any gender can be pressured or pressure), and harm is always the responsibility of the person who ignores consent, never the person it was done to. In India the age of consent is 18, so consent is taught as a life principle for safe adulthood.

Seven moves, led by the choice and the voice.

It's a consent and relationships game, so **branch** leads (read, check in, refuse, find the mutual yes), with **strike-rewrite** clearing the coercion and consent myths and **role-play** giving the actual words. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE YOUNG PERSON DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (the Mutual Zone) signature	Reads cues, checks in, refuses pressure, finds a mutual yes.	Mutual judgement.	16
reflect	Internalises the standard, the rights, the no-blame truth.	Self-application.	20
strike-rewrite	Clears a consent or coercion myth ("persistence is romance").	Conceptual change.	17
role-play (voice)	Checks in, says no, names coercion, affirms a respected boundary.	Voice; refusal.	11
sort	Sorts consent vs not; free vs coerced; green vs red.	The line.	10
spot	Spots the discomfort cue, or the coercion tactic.	Reading the room.	6
match	Pairs FRIES to its meaning; a need to its helpline.	Connections.	4

27 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

It plays warm, clear and reassuring, respect made satisfying. The positive core is the clarity and warmth of a genuine, enthusiastic 'yes'; there's real relief when a boundary is heard and honoured instantly; and naming a coercion tactic out loud, watching it lose its power, is genuinely empowering. The Mutual Zone lets a player practise getting it right, where the 'win' is always a shared yes, never a won one. Nothing is explicit; consent is never rushed.

Is it teaching?

Yes: consent as freely given, reversible, informed, enthusiastic, specific and ongoing; how to read and respect verbal and non-verbal cues; how to recognise and refuse coercion, and that pressured or incapacitated 'consent' isn't consent; that either person can stop at any time; that healthy intimacy rests on equal power and mutual respect; and that under-18s are legally protected. It is even-handed and never victim-blaming.

The belief it moves. From "consent is just no-didn't-happen; persistence is romantic; a partner owes you; once it starts you can't back out" → "consent is an enthusiastic, mutual, ongoing yes; wearing someone down is coercion; no one owes intimacy; and anyone can stop, anytime."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the standard → reading → coercion → Mutual Zone → rights/law → equal-respect arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
What consent really is (FRIES)	15	strike-rewrite, sort, match	The standard; a yes not a non-no; incapacitation.
Reading & respecting	14	spot, branch, role-play	Cues, checking in, honouring a boundary instantly.
Pressure & coercion	17	strike-rewrite, branch, spot	Refusing guilt/threats/'persistence'; even-handed; no blame.
The Mutual Zone (signature)	14	branch, role-play, reflect	Practising a shared, ongoing, enthusiastic yes.
Your right, their right & the law	12	branch, strike-rewrite, match	Stop anytime; age of consent 18; disclosure to help.
Mutual respect & equal power	12	reflect, sort, role-play	Equal power; green vs red; the lesson for life.

A coercion flip + a Mutual-Zone branch, verbatim.

```
flip: "If you keep asking, eventually it's a yes, that's just persistence."
      UN -> "Wearing someone down until they agree is just persistence."
      RE -> "Wearing someone down isn't seduction, it's coercion; a worn-down yes isn't consent."

branch: "Partway through, your partner seems to lose enthusiasm."
        best -> "Pause and check; willingness can change anytime" (consent is ongoing)
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 31 Mutual — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Consent just means no one said 'no'.	Consent is the presence of a clear, willing 'yes', not the absence of a 'no'.	The standard.
Once you say yes, you can't take it back.	Consent is reversible; either person can stop at any moment.	Reversible.
Going along with it counts as consent.	Consent is enthusiastic, both actively want it, not just tolerate it.	Enthusiastic.
Wearing someone down is just persistence.	Wearing someone down is coercion; a worn-down 'yes' isn't consent.	Coercion.
'If you loved me, you would.'	Love never comes with a price tag; that's emotional pressure, not love.	Guilt-trip.
A relationship or marriage means standing consent.	Consent is needed every time; no status means an automatic yes.	Standing-consent myth.
Someone drunk or high can still consent.	A person who is incapacitated cannot consent, full stop.	Incapacitation.
If they gave in under pressure, it's partly their fault.	Harm is always the responsibility of the person who ignored consent.	No victim-blaming.

The micro-loop.

1. **Scene.** Sam (young-adult) sets a relationship or intimacy scenario, never explicit.
2. **Communicate & read.** The young person checks in, reads cues, and responds with respect.
3. **The Mutual Zone.** The 'win' is always a shared, enthusiastic, ongoing yes, never persuasion (branch).
4. **The flip.** UN busts a consent or coercion myth; RE replaces it with the real standard.
5. **Rights, law & help.** Either can stop anytime; the law (age of consent 18); any disclosure routes straight to help.
6. **Sticker.** The Mutual badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **Mutual Zone**, practising a shared yes, plus the **coercion-defuser** that names a tactic and strips its power. It is the destination of the autonomy, boundaries and behaviour-reading taught since Chapter 1, underwrites Status: Know It (g30), and supports the identity and relationship learning of Spectrum (g32).

Strongest safeguarding in the app.

- **Consent-centred & non-explicit.** Teaches respect, communication and rights; never shows or describes explicit content.
- **Even-handed, never victim-blaming.** Harm is the responsibility of the person who ignores consent; anyone of any gender can be harmed or can harm.
- **POCSO-aware.** The age of consent (18) is stated honestly and framed as a principle for life and safe adulthood, never as encouragement for under-18 activity.
- **Urgent disclosure routing.** Any disclosure of assault, abuse or coercion routes immediately to safeguarding and the right helpline, the highest-priority triage in the app.
- **Trauma-aware.** Scenarios are realistic but non-graphic; a calm mode and easy exit are available.
- **Confidential.** The scenarios and anonymous Q&A are on-device, never tied to an identity (DPDP-aligned).
- **Access.** Audio, offline, low-end build; inclusive across gender, orientation, ability and background.

Get help (India). A woman needing help: Women Helpline 181. Women in distress: 1091. An emergency now: 112. Anyone under 18: Childline 1098. And a trusted adult or counsellor. Any disclosure of assault, abuse or coercion is routed here at once. It is never the survivor's fault.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. mutual** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **branch** Mutual Zone leads, with **strike-rewrite** for the myths and **role-play** for the words.
- **Fact-checked content.** The FRIES standard, coercion/incapacitation, the India age of consent (18, POCSO) and the helplines verified; flag any legal edit for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 24%, 0% binary, 27 autonomy, 17 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Urgent routing via the shared "get help" component (181 / 1091 / 112 / 1098 / trusted adult), the highest-priority triage in the app.
- **Tracked.** build_gate.py finalize advances g31 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): consent-centred & non-explicit; even-handed; never victim-blaming; POCSO-aware (a life principle, not encouragement); urgent disclosure routing; the 'win' is always mutual willingness; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **The enthusiastic standard prevents harm.** Because so much harm flows from a low bar ('no didn't happen'), teaching consent as a freely given, enthusiastic, ongoing, mutual yes, FRIES, is the single most protective lesson of the curriculum.
- **Naming coercion disarms it.** Since damaging scripts (persistence is romance, a partner owes you) are widely absorbed, naming guilt, threats and 'wearing someone down' as coercion, even-handedly, is what lets a young person refuse and not inflict it.
- **No blame, and a clear route to help.** Because shame and victim-blame keep harm hidden, holding firmly that it's never the survivor's fault, and routing any disclosure straight to help, is what makes the game safe and protective.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concepts 4 (consent & violence prevention) and 5 (healthy relationships); Planned Parenthood FRIES consent model (freely given, reversible, informed, enthusiastic, specific, ongoing); WHO on violence against women and consent; Government of India POCSO Act (age of consent 18) and the women's/child helplines (181, 1091, 112, 1098). Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 37 games now v2. Next by order: Spectrum (g32).